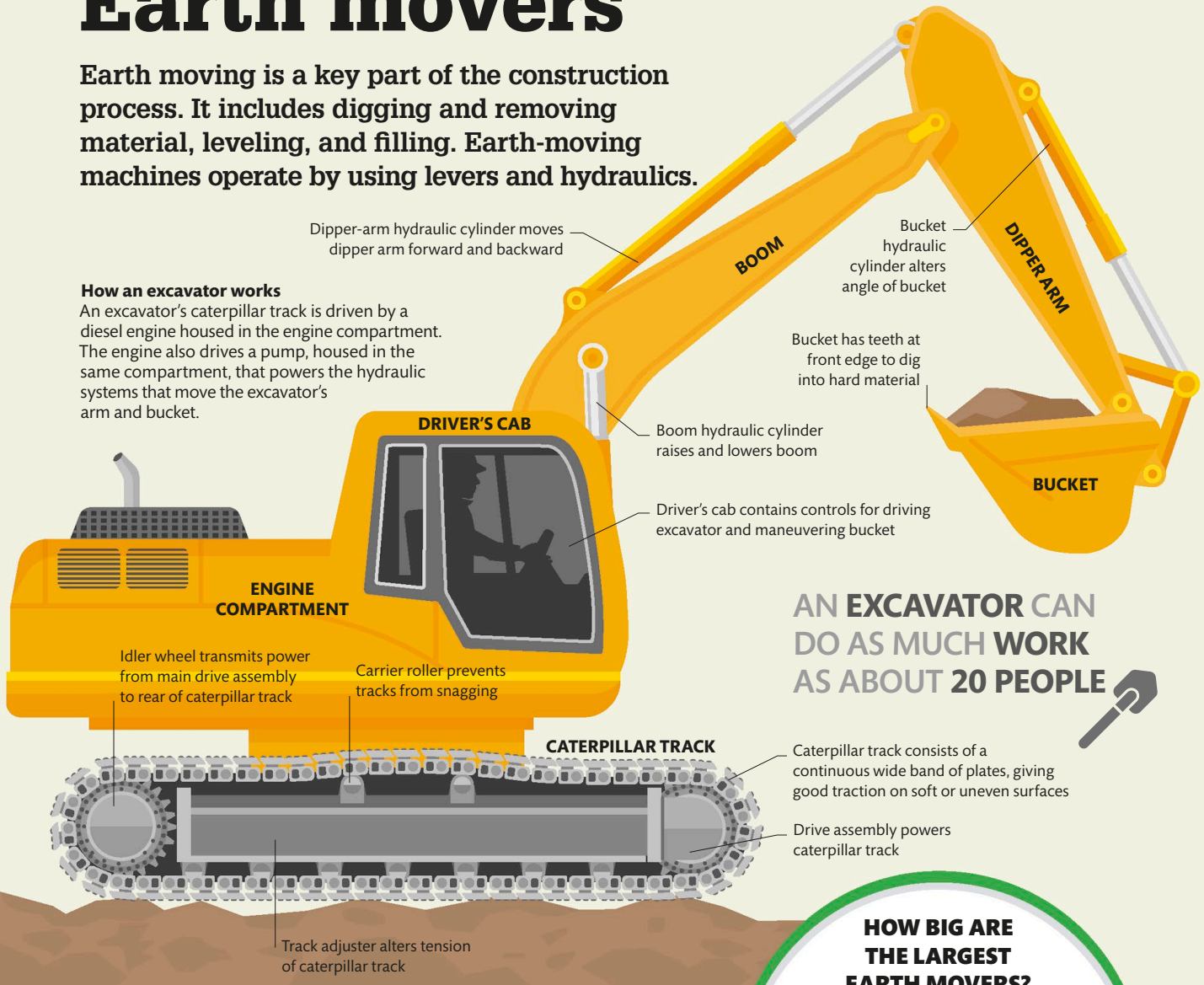
Earth movers

Earth moving is a key part of the construction process. It includes digging and removing material, leveling, and filling. Earth-moving machines operate by using levers and hydraulics.



How an excavator works
An excavator's caterpillar track is driven by a diesel engine housed in the engine compartment. The engine also drives a pump, housed in the same compartment, that powers the hydraulic systems that move the excavator's arm and bucket.

AN **EXCAVATOR** CAN DO AS MUCH **WORK** AS ABOUT **20 PEOPLE**

Earth-moving machinery

An excavator, or digger, digs into and scoops up material before depositing it elsewhere. It is one of many types of heavy earth-moving machinery used on construction sites. A bulldozer is a multipurpose earth mover that shunts material with a large, hydraulically operated front blade. A front loader is a type of tractor with a wide, front-mounted bucket used for scooping and lifting; the bucket is raised and lowered by hydraulics. A backhoe loader is a combination of a front loader and an excavator.

HOW BIG ARE THE LARGEST EARTH MOVERS?

The largest excavator is the Bucyrus RH400 hydraulic shovel, which is three stories tall, weighs 1,080 tons (980 metric tons), and can hold 1,590 cubic feet (45 cubic meters) of rock in a single scoop.